

INVITATION QUESTION

If someone watched the way I stand for truth, serve others, and handle disagreement, would they see both the strength and the love of Jesus Christ?

WITNESSING STATEMENT

The Christian faith doesn't call us to choose between truth and love. Jesus gives us a truth worth standing for and a love that governs how we stand.

MEMORY VERSE

1 Corinthians 16:13-14

"Watch, stand fast in the faith, be brave, be strong. Let all that you do be done with love."

ONE-SENTENCE TAKEAWAY

Stand firm in Christ, strengthen His servants, and let everything you do be done in love.

Before the sermon: What ties verses 10-12 to verses 13-14? Why does Paul move from two ministry relationships to commands for everyone?

PRE-SERMON NOTES

TIMOTHY AND APOLLOS

1 Corinthians 16:10-14 | 9.20.26 | Brian Tarpy

BIG IDEA

Christ's church advances when His people honor faithful workers, stand firm in the faith, and let every action be governed by love.

THE PASSAGE AT A GLANCE

1. Receive faithful servants without fear. vv. 10-11

Paul tells Corinth to make sure Timothy can work among them without intimidation. He is doing "the work of the Lord," just as Paul is.

2. Honor the worker because of the work. v. 11

Timothy is not to be despised. The church should help him continue his journey in peace. Kingdom workers should be strengthened, not needlessly burdened.

3. Different servants have different callings. v. 12

Paul strongly urged Apollos to visit Corinth, but Apollos judged that it was not the right time. Paul does not turn that difference into rivalry.

Before Sunday: Read 1 Corinthians 16:10-14 twice. Notice how Paul moves from Timothy and Apollos to five commands for the whole church.

BE READY TO TEACH. BE READY TO DISCIPLE. BE READY TO STAND.

FIVE COMMANDS FOR A MATURE CHURCH

4. Be watchful. v. 13

Stay spiritually awake. Corinth had repeatedly been vulnerable to pride, division, temptation, and false teaching. Christian maturity does not drift; it watches.

5. Stand firm in the faith. v. 13

The church is not told merely to be stubborn. It is to remain planted in "the faith" - the apostolic truth Paul has taught throughout the letter.

6. Act courageously and be strong. v. 13

Paul calls believers to mature courage. Strength is not swagger or self-reliance; it is steadfast obedience when faithfulness costs something.

7. Let everything be done in love. v. 14

This command governs all the others. Watchfulness without love becomes suspicion; firmness without love becomes harshness; courage without love becomes pride.

GOSPEL FOCUS

Jesus is the faithful Servant who completed the Father's work, loved His people to the end, died for our sins, and was raised. We do not stand firm to make ourselves acceptable to God. Because we belong to Christ, grace trains us to become steady, courageous, loving servants.

KINGDOM APPLICATION

Christ builds His Kingdom through ordinary faithfulness: receiving His servants, doing the work He gives us, standing on His truth, strengthening one another, and refusing to separate courage from love.

APPLICATION SCENARIOS

When a younger believer is serving...

Do I encourage faithful service, or make ministry harder through criticism, status, or unrealistic expectations? vv. 10-11

When another Christian makes a different judgment...

Can I distinguish disagreement over timing or wisdom from disobedience? Paul urged Apollos, yet respected his decision. v. 12

When pressure comes...

Do I know the faith well enough to stand in it, or am I easily moved by the loudest voice around me? v. 13

When courage is required...

Do I confuse Christian strength with aggression, or can I act firmly while remaining governed by love? vv. 13-14

When I serve...

Am I asking, "What recognition will I receive?" or "What work has the Lord placed before me?" v. 10

HEAD - HEART - HANDS

HEAD: What does this passage teach about how a church should view its leaders and fellow workers?

HEART: Which is harder for me: watchfulness, firmness, courage, strength, or love?

HANDS: Who can I strengthen this week so that he or she can do the work of the Lord without fear?